example, if you're running web tests, running too many browser sessions simultaneously on a single machine can slow down the machine and cause tests to fail due to browser crashes or memory limitations. For large projects, a more scalable approach is to run parallel builds on more than one machine.

### 12.5.2 Running parallel tests on multiple machines

Today, hardware is cheap and virtual machines are easy to set up. Many organizations configure their testing infrastructure so that they can devote a battery of physical and virtual machines to testing when they need to run an intensive set of tests, and then release them once the tests are finished. Continuous integration servers like Jenkins, Bamboo, and TeamCity make it easy to dispatch build jobs across several machines to better distribute the load.

You can use this distributed capability to speed up your automated acceptance criteria. This approach is illustrated in figure 12.9. The acceptance criteria ❶ need to be divided into groups that can be distributed across different build jobs, possibly on different machines ❷.

Different teams use different strategies to group acceptance criteria in this way. Tags and directory structures are both popular options. If you're using Cucumber, you

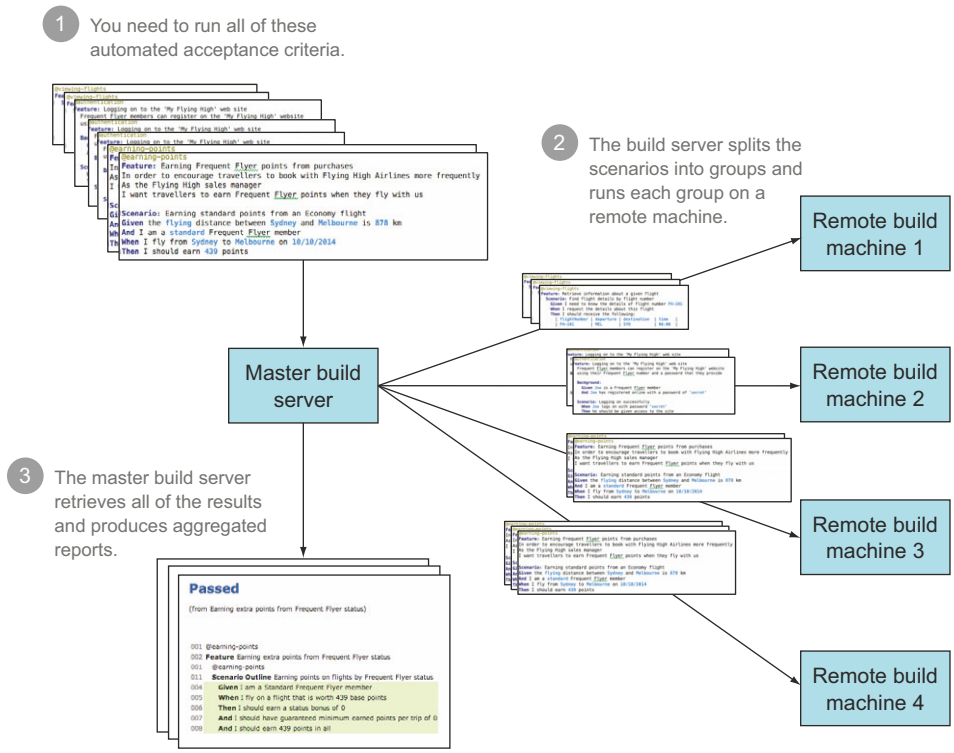



**Figure 12.9 Automated acceptance criteria can be run faster by splitting them into groups that are run on different machines.**